

M-07 — Basic Prompting

What is this about?

The first prompt you ever write — and the six-part shape that makes it work every time, not just when you get lucky.

The idea, in plain terms

Anjali handles client escalations for a Dubai office. She types "write reply to angry customer" and gets a bland three-paragraph letter with no order number and no promise in it. She deletes it and writes the email herself, the way she always has. Six short parts, in one paragraph. The first draft comes back usable instead of generic.

Key things to know

- **TASK** — what you want made. "Write a reply email."
- **CONTEXT** — who it is for and why. "To a client whose delivery slipped."
- **FACTS** — the details only you have. "Order 4471, due 12 March, now 15 March."
- **TONE** — how it should sound. "Apologetic but calm."

A simple example

Situation: Your manager forwards a 14-page site report and asks for "a summary by 5". You have 45 minutes and you have not read a word of it.

What to do: Ask your manager what the summary is for, then write the prompt.

Remember

- **Six parts, one paragraph** — Task, context, facts, tone, length, format — in plain sentences.
- **The facts are your job** — Dates, numbers and names are the part only you have. Leave them out and they get invented.
- **Say the number** — "Under 100 words." "Exactly five bullets." "Three columns." Vague in, vague out.
- **Adjectives do nothing** — "Professional", "better", "urgent" give it nothing to act on. Name the actual change.
- **Correct, don't restart** — "Keep the first two paragraphs. Cut to 80 words." One line saves the whole draft.

Inducto Learning & Knowledge — quick reference for M-07. Watch the lesson video for the full explanation; this page is a takeaway, not a replacement for it.